



Laura DeMieri walks amid a temporary 9/11 memorial dotted with flags Thursday at Pepperdine University.

Some in GOP are muting links to Trump

Rep. Young Kim of Orange County scrubs references off her campaign website.

By Nicole Nixon and Michael Wilner

SACRAMENTO — Fighting for reelection, GOP Rep. Young Kim has quietly scrubbed references to President Trump from her campaign website, a striking effort to broaden her appeal as she faces a Republican rival for her Orange County seat.

It's the latest example of a Republican distancing themselves from a historically unpopular president less than two months out from the midterm elections.

Elsewhere in California, David Valadao is strategically distancing himself from Trump in his fight for political survival in a heavily Latino congressional district. Carlos De La Cruz and Eric Flores, two Republican House candidates in Texas, deemphasized their ties to Trump on their websites after winning their primaries. And Republicans in tight Senate races in Alaska and Maine skipped Trump's unconventional midterm convention in Dallas this week.

The trend poses a challenge to Trump, whose grip on the Republican brand has been ironclad for over a decade.

On Wednesday night, at the Republican convention, Trump told voters to consider the midterms a referendum on his presidency.

"I'm asking you to pretend I'm on the ballot," he said, "just one more time."

Kim is locked in a brutal intraparty fight with Rep. Ken Calvert over one of the only safe districts left for Republicans in Southern California after voters approved new congressional boundaries last year.

Throughout the primary, both Republicans used campaign ads and mailers to play up their support for Trump and court GOP voters. But as the general election approaches, both candidates are diminishing the president's presence in their messaging by varying degrees.

Until recently, a banner on the homepage of Kim's website described her as a "Proven Fighter" who would "Stand with President Trump to deliver a bold America First Agenda," according to archived versions of the site.

As of this week, the banner said the congresswoman is "taking on Career Politicians to Restore the American Dream."

Teaching Sept. 11 as history, not memory

25 years later, educators try to convey the tragedy to a generation that didn't live through it

By Jaweed Kaleem, Howard Blume and Emily Woodruff

Trent Nettles was a toddler on Sept. 11, 2001.

Now 27, Nettles is an 11th-grade Advanced Placement U.S. history teacher — too young to remember the day but responsible for teaching it to students who weren't yet born when it happened. His challenge was to make this lesson more than just another unit on the syllabus.

Nettles told his students this week at Alliance Cindy & Bill Simon Technology High School in Watts, "I just remember, as a kid, that there was a lot of chaos. That's all."

Twenty-five years after the attacks, the anniversary has crossed a generational threshold. In a growing share of American classrooms, 9/11 is part of a past era, often taught by teachers with little more memory of it than the students in

front of them. Some do recall the morning but struggle to convey the magnitude of pain and fear to students for whom 9/11 is another date in a social studies course timeline.

The shift begins in early childhood, when children may first hear the date amid adult conversation or catch a newsflash. It runs through middle and high schools, where teachers debate how much of this history adolescent and teen students can absorb — and into college lecture halls, where professors who once taught 9/11 as a current event now teach it as decades-old history.

And inside their homes, parents find ways to impart their own lessons, translating trauma into family history.

For Heather Matula, an Atwater Village parent of [See Sept. 11, A8]

Reporting aftermath

Five TV journalists recall their experiences on 9/11 and how their lives and careers were changed. **A10**

Television as the guide

Twenty-five years ago, Americans were united in turning to TV news to get information of the day. **E1**

A condo crusade in California

Construction of new units in the state has dropped. A coalition wants to change that.

By Grace Toohey

For decades, condominiums have been one of the most affordable pathways to becoming a homeowner in the United States.

But in California — where housing affordability remains a top concern for

residents — condo production has fallen off dramatically since the early 2000s, severely limiting access to this entry-level market for homeownership.

"We're just not building them," state Assemblymember Buffy Wicks (D-Oakland) said of condos. "It's one of the elephants in the room of homeownership in California. ... You kind of don't have a choice if you're a young family looking [to buy] a house."

Between 2011 and 2021, just 3% of all new multi-unit

housing in California was condominiums. In Canada, which has a comparable population to the Golden State, condos made up almost 40% of newly built multifamily housing during that decade.

Condos are typically located in urban areas near jobs and mass transit, and cost about 15% to 30% less than single-family homes — a difference that could save buyers almost \$100,000 on a down payment in some parts of California, such as [See Condo, A8]

Higher sea levels head for the coast

Kelvin wave brings erosion threat to California's battered beaches

By Rong-Gong Lin II



Improvised renovations are made to the sea wall that protects a wooden boardwalk in Long Beach.

California beach communities are expected to see rising sea levels in the coming weeks as El Niño continues to strengthen, with more sand erosion and damage possible, according to new data.

Another El Niño-influenced phenomenon — a "coastally trapped Kelvin wave" — is moving up the coast of Mexico and will soon hit the U.S. West Coast.

This isn't a surfer's wave, and it wouldn't be overtly noticeable to swimmers or boaters either. But it is expected to increase the sea level off the California coast by another 6 inches or so, and its effects could last months, according to Dillon Amaya, an expert on coastally trapped waves and an assistant professor at North Carolina State University's Department of Marine, Earth and Atmospheric Sciences.

It might not sound like much, but another 6 inches of sea level rise could further bludgeon the already battered California coast, especially if combined with the effects from a storm. [See Waves, A6]

Trump pledges \$5,000 payouts tied to GOP win

President's campaign tactic would cost over \$1 trillion. Fiscal and legal doubts abound.

By Ana Ceballos and Michael Wilner

WASHINGTON — President Trump's pledge to give every American adult \$5,000 if Republicans retain control of Congress in November is drawing scrutiny over its legality, the price tag and whether he truly intends to follow through on such a spectacular promise.

Speaking at the Republican midterm convention in Dallas on Wednesday night, Trump told the crowd that if the GOP wins, Americans will "win with us" and get paid. He added: "It will be called the Trump Dividend."

But the proposal — which would need congressional approval — raised immediate questions about whether the president can legally promise voters a payout contingent on his party's success at the polls and drew criticism from both sides of

the aisle, including some GOP donors, who saw the idea as a potential bribe.

"I am hugely in favor of winning the midterms, and love much about this admin, but am strongly against bread and circus bribes," Joe Lonsdale, co-founder of technology firm Palantir and a Republican donor, said on X.

Legal experts, meanwhile, say the pledge — however unusual — is unlikely to run afoul of federal bribery and vote-buying statutes. It is almost certainly protected by the 1st Amendment, said UCLA law professor Rick Hasen.

"I believe they are constitutionally protected," Hasen wrote Thursday on his Election Law Blog. "How is this different from a candidate pledging if elected to secure 'medicare for all' or to cut everyone's taxes?"

Trump told CBS News after his speech that he doesn't think the payouts would need congressional approval. "I think they will do it if we needed it," he said, "but I think not."

The White House did not [See Payouts, A7]

Businesses are boosting Becerra

Big Tech and groups with interests in state back the front-runner to be next governor.

By Seema Mehta and Gabrielle Lamarr Lemee

Companies and special interest groups with some of the dickest issues expected to land on California's next governor's desk are among the top financial backers of Democrat Xavier Becerra, the gubernatorial front-runner.

Money from Big Tech, the healthcare industry, labor unions and tribes helped propel Becerra's bid for governor, which languished at the outset then took off just months before the June primary. All are major players in national and state politics and have a major financial stake in the policies of California's next governor.

Meta, which has contributed nearly \$12 million to groups backing Becerra's

campaign, has faced mounting scrutiny by lawmakers and the courts. The Menlo Park-based company, which operates social media and communication platforms such as Facebook, Instagram and WhatsApp, just agreed to a landmark \$17.1-billion settlement to resolve multistate claims that its apps endanger children.

The state Legislature in August also passed a measure to bar social media platforms from providing an "addictive feature" to lure children, as well as bills to shield Californians from threats posed by the boom in artificial intelligence and data centers. The fate of these measures is now in the hands of Gov. Gavin Newsom, and the next governor likely will have to decide whether to approve even stricter controls on Big Tech.

Meta is among eight donors that wrote seven-figure checks supporting Becerra's gubernatorial campaign, with most of the money funneled to independent [See Becerra, A11]



Residents and businesses in Eagle Rock, above, worry an Olympics transportation project will bring bottleneck traffic. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

TRANSIT ANXIETY

Residents and businesses in Eagle Rock, above, worry an Olympics transportation project will bring bottleneck traffic. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Confusion over protected status

Salvadorans in limbo as a deadline passed with no clear decision on Temporary Protected Status. **NATION, A5**

Weather

Sunshine and warm. L.A. Basin: 90/70. **B6**

Markets

..... **A12**

Opinion Voices

..... **A13**

Ex-Kings coach Melrose dies

His long career in broadcasting helped expand the audience for hockey. **SPORTS, B10**

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